ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** show his dedication in harsh conditions	Hardship.
2	**(b)** Khetaram delivers post in a desert area.	Fact.
3	**(b)** Many letters have been delivered by him.	Have been delivered.
4	**(c)** many cannot read and trust him with private news	Trust.
5	**(c)** Khetaram deserves our highest respect.	Opinion.
6	**(b)** He asked her where she lived.	Wh-question.
7	**(c)** carries a relative's care	Emotional value.
8	**(a)** power to hurt and heal	Power.
9	**(b)** must	Duty.
10	**(d)** a lifeline to the outside world	Lifeline.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He brings news that affects families (1) and sometimes reads private letters aloud (1).	1+1
12	Letters hold feelings (1) so he carries hopes and relationships (1).	1+1
13	They make an abstract idea visible (1) and help us feel the force of words (1).	1+1
14	It is essential for survival (1) because it connects people and money to remote homes (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	By describing his hardships (1). By showing his honesty (1). By presenting villagers' trust (1).	1+1+1
16	To match the simple setting (1). To honour the subject (1). To reach all readers (1).	1+1+1
17	The postman who serves the village is honest (1). 'Who' joins the clauses (1). It avoids repetition (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He serves remote homes (1). He helps the unlettered (1). He links isolated communities (1).	1+1+1
18	Words connect people (1). They carry feelings (1). Careful words keep bridges safe (1).	1+1+1
	OR: His arrival gave a ray of hope (1). He was a man of his word (1). Idioms show hope and reliability (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hard conditions (1). Dedication (1). Trust of villagers (1). Little recognition (1). The writer's tribute (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Devices (1). Language (1). Tone (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1
20	Reaches the unreachable (1). Money orders (1). Letters (1). Help for the unlettered (1). National integration (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Chapter: written letters (1). Poem: spoken words (1). Both carry feeling (1). Both need care (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying Khetaram is a postman in a city. He is a **Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS)**, a rural postal worker in the desert region of Rajasthan; do not write 'General Delivery Service'.
- Listing only 'delivering letters' as his work. The chapter also shows him reading letters aloud, because many villagers cannot read, and delivering money orders sent by relatives working far away.
- Giving 'traffic and crowds' as his difficulties. His work is hard because of heat, distance and sand, so use these desert details in the answer.
- Missing the larger point: the postman is a link between remote families and the outside world and carries hope as well as news. The tone of the lesson is respectful and appreciative.
- Mixing the poem with the prose: 'Words' warns that careless words can hurt and advises speaking with care and sincerity. Its mood is thoughtful, not angry.

- Grammar slips: *Khetaram **has delivered** letters for many years* (present perfect, not 'deliver ... since years'); the opposite of 'trust' is *distrust*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** cannot be called back	Irreversibility.
2	**(d)** isn't he	Tag.
3	**(b)** he delivers every letter safely	Reliability.
4	**(b)** think before they speak	Reflection.
5	**(c)** does more than expected	Extra effort.
6	**(a)** emotional as well as physical carrying	Both.
7	**(c)** words can wound	Hurt.
8	**(b)** deliver	Verb form.
9	**(d)** metaphor	Direct comparison.
10	**(c)** comes from the heart	Honest.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Phones and online banking reduce letters (1) but remote villages still need a trusted human link (1).	1+1
12	Silence is better than careless speech (1) but kind words are still best (1).	1+1
13	He handles money and private news (1) and people must rely on his honesty (1).	1+1
14	Spoken words cannot be taken back (1) so they must be chosen carefully (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Money orders sustain families (1). Letters bring comfort (1). Both reduce the pain of distance (1).	1+1+1
16	It shows words as arrows (1). It stresses their lasting effects (1). It advises thought before speaking (1).	1+1+1
17	Name the messenger (1). Both carry messages (1). Both are trusted (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He sees it as a duty (1). He takes pride in it (1). He serves with kindness (1).	1+1+1
18	Metaphor (1). Simile (1). Repetition (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It shows the effect of words (1). It uses direct advice (1). It leaves the choice to us (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Khetaram's honest work (1). Respect from villagers (1). Pride in service (1). Dignity of labour (1). Our duty to respect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). The person (1). The letter arrives (1). The effect (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
20	Describes the landscape (1). Describes the work (1). Shows trust (1). Appreciative tone (1). Effect on reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem's idea (1). Examples (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Missing the larger point: the postman is a link between remote families and the outside world and carries hope as well as news. The tone of the lesson is respectful and appreciative.
- Mixing the poem with the prose: 'Words' warns that careless words can hurt and advises speaking with care and sincerity. Its mood is thoughtful, not angry.

- Grammar slips: *Khetaram **has delivered** letters for many years* (present perfect, not 'deliver ... since years'); the opposite of 'trust' is *distrust*.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** dependable	Dependable.
2	**(a)** appreciative	Tribute.
3	**(b)** readers who value kindness	Audience.
4	**(b)** Khetaram, the postman, arrived at noon.	Appositive in commas.
5	**(a)** anxiety for families	Delay hurts.
6	**(b)** emphasis on the theme	Emphasis.
7	**(a)** slowly	Modifies the verb.
8	**(b)** absolutely necessary	Indispensable.
9	**(b)** carrying words and choosing words	Link.
10	**(b)** The Man Who Carries Words Across the Sands	Relevant.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Both care about how messages reach people (1) and what they do to them (1).	1+1
12	Harsh conditions show his endurance (1) and need for kindness (1).	1+1
13	It shows both hurting and healing (1) and advises care (1).	1+1
14	Value those who serve (1) and speak and write responsibly (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Mutual trust (1). Dependence for news and money (1). Respect and affection (1).	1+1+1
16	The villager told him that he had brought good news (1). Present perfect becomes past perfect (1). 'You' becomes 'he' (1).	1+1+1
17	Tone changes meaning (1). Soft tone comforts (1). Harsh tone wounds (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sand and heat show hardship (1). Distances show effort (1). They make the postman heroic (1).	1+1+1
18	People depend on Khetaram because he walks daily (1). 'Because' gives reason (1). It makes a complex sentence (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Communication needs carriers and care (1). Both effort and choice matter (1). It builds bonds (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Headline (1). Introduction (1). Khetaram's example (1). Challenges (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). The request (1). Khetaram's advice (1). Challenges (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Power of words (1). Harm (1). Healing (1). Advice (1). Effect on the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Digital messages (1). Postmen's role (1). Words remain powerful (1). Need for responsible use (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND